

KVTC outperforms existing methods such as KIVI, GEAR, H2O, and TOVA, which degrade beyond ~5x compression. The technique will integrate into NVIDIA Dynamo's KV Block Manager and supports open ecosystems via vLLM, signalling a move towards a standardised compression layer for scalable AI.

Rakuten open sources its largest Japanese LLM to accelerate local AI innovation

Rakuten Group has open sourced its latest large language model, Rakuten AI 3.0, under the Apache 2.0 license, making it freely available via its Hugging Face repository to accelerate AI development and community collaboration.

Positioned as Japan's largest high-performance LLM, the model is designed to support companies and professionals



building AI applications, signalling a strategic move to democratise access to advanced, locally optimised AI and reduce dependence on global, English-centric models.

Rakuten AI 3.0 is optimised for Japanese language tasks and delivers strong performance across writing, code generation, document analysis, and extraction. Compared to earlier models, it demonstrates significantly higher accuracy and robustness.

The model has been benchmarked across Japanese cultural knowledge, history, graduate-level reasoning, competitive mathematics, and instruction following, with results compared against leading Japanese-focused models.

The development is backed by Japan's GENIAC initiative, with support from the Ministry of Economy, Trade

and Industry (METI) and the New Energy and Industrial Technology Development Organization (NEDO), which provided compute resources for training.

"Rakuten is continuously pushing the boundaries of innovation to develop best-in-class LLMs for R&D and deliver best-in-class AI services to its customers. By making the models open to all, Rakuten aims to contribute to the open source community and accelerate the development of local AI applications and Japanese language LLMs," said Ting Cai, Chief AI & Data Officer, Rakuten.

The model was unveiled in December 2025 and later fine-tuned for release, reinforcing open source AI as a competitive and collaborative pathway for Japan's ecosystem.

NeoNephos expands its open source cloud ecosystem with new members

NeoNephos Foundation has expanded its pan-European open source cloud coalition with the addition of BWI GmbH as a



Premier Member, SUSE LLC as a General Member, and Fraunhofer ISST as an Associate Member. The move strengthens efforts to build an open, interoperable, federated cloud infrastructure aligned with Europe's digital sovereignty goals.

The expansion reinforces NeoNephos as a critical building block in the EU's sovereign digital and security architecture, advancing open source technologies for a federated cloud-to-edge continuum. The initiative supports the EU's IPCEI-CIS

programme, enabling seamless cloud and edge service usage across providers while reducing vendor lock-in.

"Open source collaboration is essential for building the next generation of trusted cloud infrastructure," said Christian Neu, Governing Board Chair, NeoNephos Foundation. "The addition of BWI GmbH, SUSE LLC and Fraunhofer ISST to the NeoNephos member community demonstrates strong momentum behind open, interoperable cloud technologies that give organizations greater choice, flexibility and control over their infrastructure."

The new members bring combined expertise across industry, public sector, and research, accelerating innovation across cloud infrastructure, SaaS, platform services, and public systems.

"NeoNephos offers us an exciting partner network with which we want to advance lifecycle management in an edge-cloud continuum," said Heinrich Pettenpohl, Head of Department IT Service Providers, Fraunhofer ISST. "Our goal is to shift and reduce resource consumption and adapt it to the required environments and use cases. We also look forward to collaborating on infrastructure assistants for optimization and error analysis."

"For over 30 years, SUSE has pioneered open source solutions to deliver unparalleled choice and innovation to our customers," said Diego Akechi, General Manager, SAP Business Unit, SUSE. "Joining NeoNephos reinforces our commitment to open source and our core beliefs around collaboration and trust as the way to accelerate innovation for the EU open source community."

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